

PLI scheme for mobile manufacture showing good results

Under the production linked incentive (PLI) scheme for large scale electronics manufacturing, mobile manufacturers produced goods worth 35,000 crore rupees (approx. US\$4.7 billion @ 1US\$=₹75) and invested 1,300 crore rupees (approx. US\$173.3 million) in the December 2020 quarter, as per Ministry of Commerce and Industry's official statement. Companies whose proposals have been approved include Samsung and Rising Star. Apple's suppliers Foxconn, Wistron, and Pegatron have also been approved. The PLI scheme approved sixteen applications with an incentive outlay of 36,440 crore rupees (approx. US\$4.9 billion) in its first round.

PLI scheme for solar PV modules manufacture approved

The Union Cabinet has approved a production linked incentive (PLI) scheme aiming to expand the manufacturing capacity of high-efficiency solar photovoltaic (PV) modules. The scheme has a budget outlay of 4,500 crore rupees (about US\$600 million) and looks forward to generating a demand of 17,500 crore rupees (about US\$2.3 billion) over five years for 'Balance of Materials' and import substitution of around 17,500 crore rupees every year. The government expects 7,920 crore rupees (about US\$1056 million) worth of incremental investment, incremental production of 168,000 crore rupees (about US\$22.4 billion), exports worth 64,400 crore rupees (about US\$8.6 billion) and earn direct and indirect revenues of 49,300 crore rupees (about US\$6.6 billion), along with creating 400,000 employment opportunities. The solar PV manufacturers will be selected through a transparent competitive bidding process.

Cabinet approves PLI scheme for white goods

The Union Cabinet has approved a production linked incentive (PLI) scheme for white goods (air-con-



Representational image

ditioners and LED lights) with a budget of 6,238 crore rupees (about US\$832 million). Air-conditioner and LED light manufacturing companies will receive an incentive of four to six percent on incremental sales of goods manufactured in India for a period of five years. The official statement added that mere assembly of finished goods shall not be incentivised.

India to become top EV maker in the world: Nitin Gadkari

Union Minister Nitin Gadkari recently said that lithium-ion batteries would be manufactured fully in the country in the next six months and India will become number one electric vehicle (EV) maker in the world in due course of time. He added that the government wants to encourage automakers to introduce flex-fuel

engines in India and he is in final discussion with the manufacturers. The minister also pointed out that in the next two years, the cost of EVs will come down to the level of petrol and diesel vehicles. He said that the quality of EVs manufactured in India would be of the international standard.

DoT restricts equipment purchase for satellite services

The Department of Telecom (DoT) has issued new guidelines under which telecom companies offering satellite connectivity services through gateway set-up in the country will be required to install network equipment as recommended by the government. The new rules take effect from June 15 this year. The licensee, as per DoT, shall only connect trusted products in its network and seek permission from